

Software Requirements Specification (SRS)

Chess Learning Platform (Chess.com-Inspired)

1. Introduction

This document follows the **IEEE 29148:2018 Software Requirements Specification (SRS)** standard, defining system requirements, constraints, risks, and lifecycle considerations.

1.1 Purpose

This Software Requirements Specification (SRS) document defines the functional and non-functional requirements for the development of an online chess learning platform similar to Chess.com. The platform will provide free and paid chess courses, subscription-based learning, interactive lessons powered by the Stockfish chess engine, and analytics-driven progress tracking.

This document serves as a reference for developers, designers, stakeholders, and future maintainers of the system.

1.2 Scope

The system will: - Allow students to learn chess via structured courses - Offer free and premium (paid) content - Provide subscription-based access - Integrate Stockfish for chess analysis and learning - Track user progress and performance - Support instructors and administrators for content management

The platform will be developed using Django (backend) with optional React-based frontend enhancements.

1.3 Intended Audience

- Software Developers
 - Project Managers
 - UI/UX Designers
 - Chess Instructors
 - Quality Assurance Engineers
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1.4 Definitions, Acronyms, and Abbreviations

- **MVC/MTV:** Model View Controller / Model Template View
- **LMS:** Learning Management System
- **API:** Application Programming Interface

- **SRS:** Software Requirements Specification
 - **FEN:** Forsyth-Edwards Notation
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2. Overall Description

2.1 Product Perspective

The system is a web-based application built on Django, following a modular app-based architecture. The platform will initially use Django Templates (MTV) and later integrate React for enhanced interactivity.

The system integrates third-party services such as: - Stripe (payments) - Stockfish (chess engine) - Video hosting platforms (Vimeo / YouTube)

2.2 Product Functions

High-level features include: - User authentication and role management - Course catalog and lesson delivery - Video-based and interactive chess lessons - Subscription and payment management - Chess engine analysis - Progress tracking and analytics - Admin and instructor dashboards

2.3 User Classes and Characteristics

User Type	Description
Student	Learns chess, enrolls in courses, views progress
Instructor	Creates and manages courses and lessons
Admin	Manages users, payments, analytics, and system settings

2.4 Operating Environment

- Backend: Django + Django REST Framework
 - Frontend: Django Templates (initial), React (later)
 - Database: PostgreSQL
 - Hosting: AWS / DigitalOcean
 - Browser Support: Chrome, Firefox, Edge, Safari
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2.5 Design and Implementation Constraints

- Must comply with Stripe payment policies
- Secure handling of user data

- Scalable architecture for future mobile apps
 - Chess engine integration must not overload server
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2.6 Assumptions and Dependencies

- Users have stable internet access
 - Chess engine computations run server-side
 - Video content hosted externally
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3. System Features and Requirements

3.1 User Authentication Module

Functional Requirements

- User registration and login
 - Email verification
 - Password reset
 - Role-based access control
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3.2 Course Management Module

Functional Requirements

- Admin/Instructor can create, edit, delete courses
 - Courses categorized by difficulty and topic
 - Lessons organized in sequence
 - Support for free and paid courses
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3.3 Lesson Delivery Module

Functional Requirements

- Video lessons playback
 - Text-based lesson material
 - Lesson completion tracking
 - Resume last watched lesson
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3.4 Enrollment and Progress Tracking Module

Functional Requirements

- Students can enroll in courses
 - Track lesson completion
 - Show course progress percentage
 - Store timestamps and activity logs
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3.5 Payment and Subscription Module

Functional Requirements

- Integration with Stripe
 - One-time payments for courses
 - Monthly subscription plans
 - Automatic subscription renewal
 - Invoice generation
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3.6 Chess Engine Integration Module

Functional Requirements

- Load chessboard using FEN/PGN
 - Analyze positions using Stockfish
 - Display best move suggestions
 - Provide evaluation scores
 - Detect blunders and inaccuracies
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3.7 Interactive Learning Module

Functional Requirements

- Guess-the-move exercises
 - Engine-based hints
 - Adaptive difficulty
 - Feedback after each move
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3.8 Dashboard and Analytics Module

Functional Requirements

- Student progress dashboard

- Strength/weakness analysis
 - Admin analytics dashboard
 - Enrollment and revenue reports
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3.9 Blog and SEO Module

Functional Requirements

- Admin can publish blog posts
 - SEO-friendly URLs
 - Categorized articles
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4. External Interface Requirements

4.1 User Interfaces

- Responsive web UI
 - Chessboard UI
 - Admin dashboard
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4.2 Hardware Interfaces

- No special hardware required
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4.3 Software Interfaces

- Stripe API
 - Stockfish engine
 - Email services (SMTP)
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4.4 Communication Interfaces

- HTTPS-based API communication
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5. Non-Functional Requirements

5.1 Performance Requirements

- Engine analysis response < 2 seconds

- Page load time < 3 seconds
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5.2 Security Requirements

- Encrypted passwords
 - Secure payment processing
 - Role-based authorization
 - CSRF and XSS protection
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5.3 Scalability Requirements

- Support increasing users
 - Modular app design
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5.4 Reliability Requirements

- 99% uptime
 - Regular backups
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5.5 Usability Requirements

- Beginner-friendly UI
 - Clear navigation
 - Mobile-responsive design
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6. Project Timeline, Risk Analysis, and Milestones

The project is planned over a duration of **6 months**, divided into structured phases. Each phase includes objectives, risks, mitigation strategies, and associated use cases.

6.1 Phase 1 – Foundation & Architecture (Month 1)

Purpose: Establish a strong technical and architectural base.

Key Goals: - Finalize system architecture - Set up Django project structure - Implement authentication and roles

Deliverables: - Django project skeleton - Custom user model - Secure login/signup

Risks & Mitigation: | Risk | Impact | Mitigation | |----|-----|-----| | Poor architecture decisions | High | Design reviews and modular app structure | | Security misconfiguration | High | Follow Django security best practices |

Primary Use Cases: - UC-01: User Registration - UC-02: User Login - UC-03: Role Assignment

6.2 Phase 2 – Course Management & LMS Core (Month 2)

Purpose: Enable structured learning via courses and lessons.

Key Goals: - Develop course catalog - Implement lesson sequencing - Track progress

Deliverables: - Course & lesson modules - Progress tracking

Risks & Mitigation: | Risk | Impact | Mitigation | |----|-----|-----| | Poor content organization | Medium | Use hierarchical course models | | Scalability issues | Medium | Normalize database schema |

Primary Use Cases: - UC-04: Browse Courses - UC-05: Enroll in Free Course - UC-06: View Lesson Content

6.3 Phase 3 – Payments & Subscriptions (Month 3)

Purpose: Introduce monetization.

Key Goals: - Stripe integration - Subscription lifecycle handling

Deliverables: - Payment module - Subscription management

Risks & Mitigation: | Risk | Impact | Mitigation | |----|-----|-----| | Payment failures | High | Stripe webhooks and retries | | Unauthorized access | High | Subscription middleware checks |

Primary Use Cases: - UC-07: Purchase Course - UC-08: Subscribe to Plan - UC-09: Cancel Subscription

6.4 Phase 4 – Chess Engine & Interactive Learning (Month 4)

Purpose: Add intelligence-driven learning.

Key Goals: - Integrate Stockfish - Enable interactive board lessons

Deliverables: - Engine analysis API - Interactive chess lessons

Risks & Mitigation: | Risk | Impact | Mitigation | |----|-----|-----| | High server load | High | Engine depth limits and caching | | Incorrect analysis | Medium | Validate with test positions |

Primary Use Cases: - UC-10: Analyze Position - UC-11: Receive Move Feedback

6.5 Phase 5 – Advanced UI & Analytics (Month 5)

Purpose: Improve UX and insights.

Key Goals: - Introduce REST APIs - Add React dashboard

Deliverables: - Analytics dashboard - React-based UI

Risks & Mitigation: | Risk | Impact | Mitigation | |----|-----|-----| | API inconsistency | Medium | API documentation and testing | | UX complexity | Medium | Iterative UI testing |

Primary Use Cases: - UC-12: View Progress Analytics - UC-13: Receive Notifications

6.6 Phase 6 – Testing, Deployment & Launch (Month 6)

Purpose: Production readiness.

Key Goals: - System testing - Deployment

Deliverables: - Live system - Deployment documentation

Risks & Mitigation: | Risk | Impact | Mitigation | |----|-----|-----| | Deployment failure | High | Staging environment testing | | Data loss | High | Automated backups |

Primary Use Cases: - UC-14: System Monitoring - UC-15: Admin Maintenance

7. Future Enhancements

- Mobile applications (Android/iOS)
 - AI-based personalized training plans
 - Multiplayer learning modes
 - Coach-student live sessions
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7. Appendix

7.1 Technology Stack Summary

- Backend: Django, DRF
- Frontend: Django Templates, React

- Database: PostgreSQL
 - Payments: Stripe
 - Chess Engine: Stockfish
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7.2 Revision History

Version	Date	Description
1.0	Initial	Initial SRS Draft

End of Document